

POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES

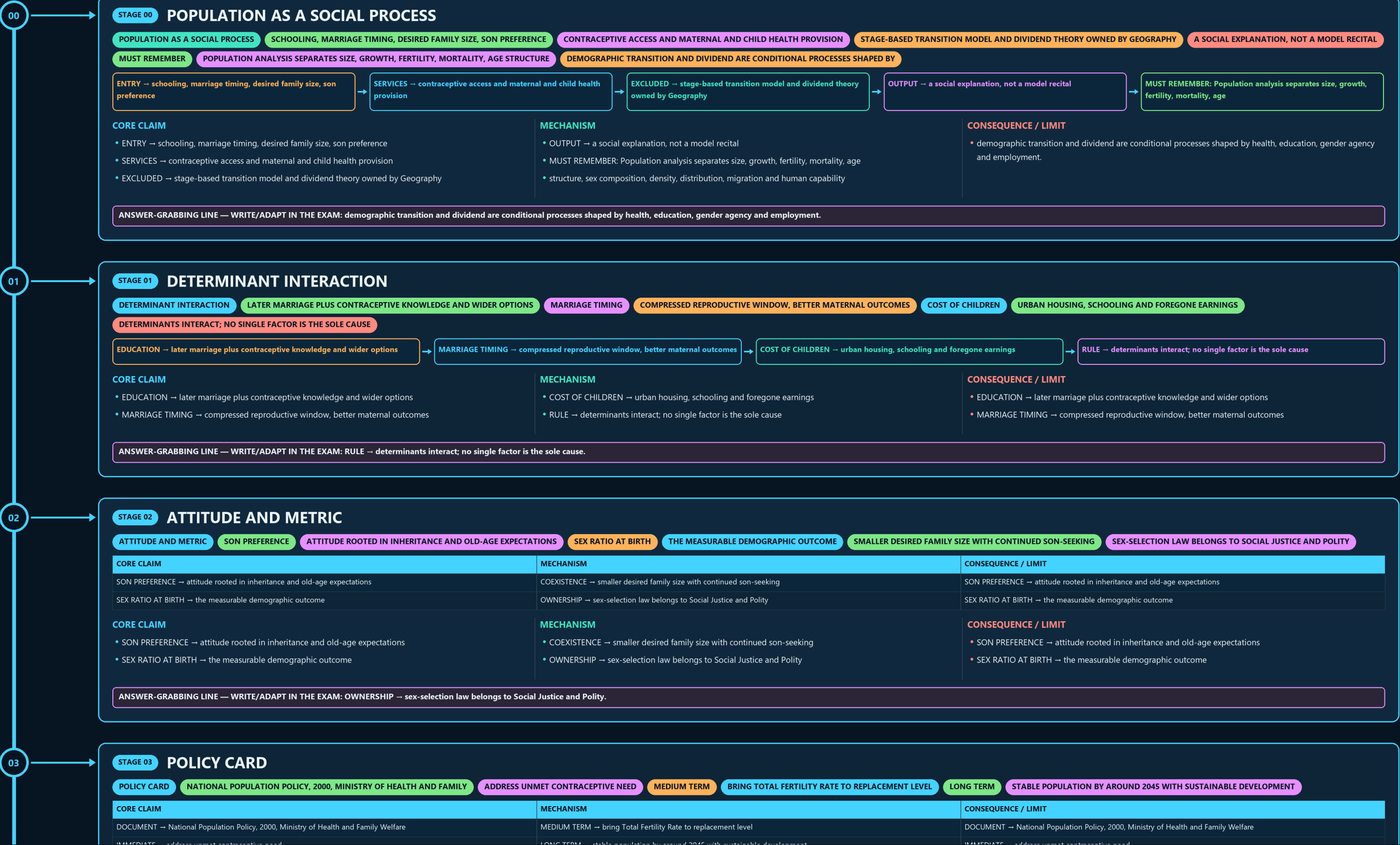
POPULATION AS A SOCIAL → DETERMINANT INTERACTION → ATTITUDE AND METRIC → POLICY CARD → EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER → AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

SON PREFERENCE → attitude rooted in inheritance and old-age expectations

SEX RATIO AT BIRTH → the measurable demographic outcome

COEXISTENCE → smaller desired family size with continued son-seeking

OWNERSHIP → sex-selection law belongs to Social Justice and Polity

SON PREFERENCE → attitude rooted in inheritance and old-age expectations

SEX RATIO AT BIRTH → the measurable demographic outcome

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OWNERSHIP → sex-selection law belongs to Social Justice and Polity.

03

STAGE 03

POLICY CARD

POLICY CARD

NATIONAL POPULATION POLICY, 2000, MINISTRY OF HEALTH AND FAMILY

ADDRESS UNMET CONTRACEPTIVE NEED

MEDIUM TERM

BRING TOTAL FERTILITY RATE TO REPLACEMENT LEVEL

LONG TERM

STABLE POPULATION BY AROUND 2045 WITH SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare	MEDIUM TERM → bring Total Fertility Rate to replacement level	DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need	LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development	IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need

CORE CLAIM

DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need

MECHANISM

MEDIUM TERM → bring Total Fertility Rate to replacement level

LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development.

04

STAGE 04

EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

RELEASED 29 MAY 2026, TOTAL 2.0, URBAN 1.6, RURAL

2019-21 ROUND, TOTAL FERTILITY RATE 2.0, HISTORICAL COMPARATOR

2011 IS THE LAST COMPLETED FULL COUNT; CENSUS 2027

NO SURVEY AVERAGE MAY BE QUOTED AS A STATE

NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional

NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator

CENSUS → 2011 is the last completed full count; Census 2027 is prospective

PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator	CENSUS → 2011 is the last completed full count; Census 2027 is prospective PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock	NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock.

05

STAGE 05

AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

A WEIGHTED SUMMARY OF STATES IN DIFFERENT TRANSITION PHASES

BELOW REPLACEMENT

AGEING PRESSURE AND WORKFORCE-SHRINKAGE RISK

ABOVE REPLACEMENT

YOUNG STRUCTURE WITH AN OPEN DIVIDEND WINDOW

THE HONEST ANSWER IS STATE-GRADED, NOT NATION-UNIFORM

CLOSE DISTINCTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases	VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform	survey flow, and demographic dividend is an opportunity rather than an automatic bonus.
BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Population growth is not fertility, replacement fertility is not zero growth, density is	
ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window	not pressure, sex ratio at birth is not overall sex ratio, Census stock is not	

CORE CLAIM

NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases

BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk

ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window

MECHANISM

VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Population growth is not fertility, replacement fertility is not zero growth, density is

not pressure, sex ratio at birth is not overall sex ratio, Census stock is not

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

survey flow, and demographic dividend is an opportunity rather than an automatic bonus.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform.

06

STAGE 06

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

SUSTAINED SUB-REPLACEMENT FERTILITY WITH AGEING AND DECLINE

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

LARGEST WORKING-AGE SHARE, GROWTH-FAVOURABLE WINDOW

NEAR-OPPOSITE PHASES OF THE SAME TRANSITION

A LARGE COUNTRY CAN DISPLAY BOTH ACROSS ITS REGIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
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POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2559-5793 of 10910 • continues below

06

• BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk

• ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window

• CLOSE DISTINCTION: Population growth is not fertility, replacement fertility is not zero growth, density is

• not pressure, sex ratio at birth is not overall sex ratio, Census stock is not

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform.

06

STAGE 06

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

SUSTAINED SUB-REPLACEMENT FERTILITY WITH AGEING AND DECLINE

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

LARGEST WORKING-AGE SHARE, GROWTH-FAVOURABLE WINDOW

NEAR-OPPOSITE PHASES OF THE SAME TRANSITION

A LARGE COUNTRY CAN DISPLAY BOTH ACROSS ITS REGIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline	RELATION → near-opposite phases of the same transition	DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline
DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window	CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions	DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

CORE CLAIM

• DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline

• DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

MECHANISM

• RELATION → near-opposite phases of the same transition

• CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline

• DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions.

07

STAGE 07

AGEING DOUBLE READING

AGEING DOUBLE READING

LONGER LIFE FROM SUCCESSFUL MORTALITY AND HEALTH TRANSITION

RISING OLD-AGE DEPENDENCY AND WORKFORCE RECOMPOSITION

FAMILY-BASED CARE WEAKENED BY NUCLEARISATION

FORMAL OLD-AGE SECURITY NOT YET SCALED WHERE FERTILITY FELL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition	SUPPORT → family-based care weakened by nuclearisation	ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition
BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition	GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest	BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

CORE CLAIM

• ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition

• BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

MECHANISM

• SUPPORT → family-based care weakened by nuclearisation

• GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition

• BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest.

08

STAGE 08

TWO TRANSITION FRAMEWORKS

TWO TRANSITION FRAMEWORKS

FIRST TRANSITION

MORTALITY DECLINE FOLLOWED BY FERTILITY DECLINE

SECOND TRANSITION

VALUE AND FAMILY-FORMATION SHIFT BELOW REPLACEMENT

THE SECOND FRAMEWORK IS LARGELY EUROPEAN IN DERIVATION

AN ANALYTICAL LENS, NEVER AN ESTABLISHED INDIAN DIAGNOSIS

FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline

SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement

ORIGIN → the second framework is largely European in derivation

STATUS → an analytical lens, never an established Indian diagnosis

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline	• ORIGIN → the second framework is largely European in derivation	• FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline
• SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement	• STATUS → an analytical lens, never an established Indian diagnosis	• SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement.

09

STAGE 09

MIGRATION OFFSET

MIGRATION OFFSET

RECEIVING REGION

WORKING-AGE INFLOW CUSHIONS WORKFORCE SHRINKAGE

SENDING REGION

ELDERLY PARENTS LEFT WITH THINNER HOUSEHOLD SUPPORT

NET EFFECT

THE AGEING PROBLEM IS REDISTRIBUTED, NOT REMOVED

ANSWER USE

RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage

SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support

NET EFFECT → the ageing problem is redistributed, not removed

ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage	• NET EFFECT → the ageing problem is redistributed, not removed	• RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage
• SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support	• ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility	• SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support

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